

EUR 400 million a year to keep energy prices fixed?

The Finance Minister's pre-budget figures, tested against EU data

THE CLAIM

"I expect those numbers to remain at the same level next year."

Clyde Caruana, Minister for Finance, Pre-Budget Document 2027 launch, 30 Sep 2026 (BusinessNow)

On energy subsidies of about EUR 400m this year (EUR 391.7m presented) and the same next year.

He also said fuel, electricity and gas prices "have not changed". Pre-Budget Document not read (403).

VERDICT

NOT SUBSTANTIATED

*Prices held, as stated;
the EUR 400m cannot yet be tested.*

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

0.0%

Prices unchanged

Malta's energy prices in the year to Aug 2026; EU-27 +13.0%. The only EU country with no rise.

EUR 1.21

Diesel, fixed since 2020

A litre in every weekly EU Oil Bulletin since 15 Jun 2020; EU average EUR 2.15 on 5 Oct 2026.

391.7m

An estimate, not spending

EUR, the minister's 2026 figure (energy and food). No 2026 spending figure yet; amount not shown elsewhere.

41%

Forecasts have missed

The Government's 2023 figure (EUR 242.5m) against EUR 595m planned for 2023 in October 2022.

1.1%

Not alone in subsidising

Of GDP on fuel and energy subsidies in 2024 (Eurostat): Bulgaria and Slovakia the same, Hungary 1.3%.

FAIR TO SAY

The minister gave next year's figure as an expectation and said the bill could rise with world prices. His earlier figures fit Eurostat and the IMF. Keeping prices fixed in 2027 is a commitment, labelled "not yet due".

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ The breakdown of the EUR 391.7m by measure.

☐ The price assumptions behind 2027.

☐ Yearly spending on the same basis since 2022.

☐ 2026 spending data when published.